JULY 19, 2025

TREASURE HUNT

PROJECT REPORT

Shahiba Shamshad, Mounia Touil, Michael Butler, Oluwatomisin Umar Adegbayi

TREASURE HUNT

TreasureHunt is a fully working online auction platform that draws inspiration from eBay and similar systems. It allows users to display products, put bids, make offers, and make direct purchases in a safe and engaging setting. It was created to digitize and expand a conventional on-site auction business. Although both registered and guest users are supported on the platform, only registered users are able to actively engage in buying and selling.

KEY FUNCTIONAL FEATURES

User Registration & Login: Secure sign-up and login with hashed passwords, session-based authentication.
Item Listing: Registered users can post auction items with descriptions, images, price, duration.
C**ategorized Item Browsing:** Users can browse items grouped by category (e.g., Electronics, Jewelry, Health and beauty).
Live Auction & Bidding: Real-time bidding with highest bid display, minimum bid validation.
Buy Now & Make an Offer: Allows instant purchase or price negotiation.
Guest Browsing: Guests can view items but must register to buy/sell.
Admin Panel: Admins can monitor items, bids, and system statistics.
Reports: Admin can generate reports.
Responsive UI: Designed for desktop and mobile using HTML, CSS, JavaScript.
Watchlist & Cart: Registered users can add items to Watchlist or Cart.

TECHNICAL STACK

File Structure: All .php and .html files under treasure_hunt/.
Frontend: HTML5, CSS3 (external style.css), JavaScript (modular).
Backend: PHP 7+
Database: MySQL (via XAMPP, PDO used for DB interaction)
Session Management: PHP $_SESSION for user tracking

REQUIREMENT MAPPING

1. **Users with full profiles:** Users table stores username, password, address, hashed password, shipping info, card info.
2. **Guest and registered user access:** Guests can browse; only registered users can buy/sell.
3. **Secure registration and login:** Passwords hashed with password_hash(), Three limited login attempts after which its directed back to login page.
4. **Auction listings with start/end time and description:** Items table includes StartTime, EndTime, Description, ImageURL. Decription opens up to new page which has product details.
5. **Categories:** Categories table with mappings in Items.
6. **Bidding:**Bids table with real-time bid checks and validation against rules.
7. **View all items with grouped categories:** Items displayed using PHP and JavaScript, grouped by CategoryName.
8. **Buy Now, Make Offer, and Watchlist features:** Implemented using separate pages: buy_now.php, make_offer.php.
9. **Admin interface for monitoring:** AdminPanel.php includes stats, table viewer, charts, and CSV exports.
10. **Mobile-friendly design:** All pages are responsive, styled using external CSS and media queries.

SECURITY:

1. Passwood are hashed before storage.
2. Admin and user sessions are separated via $_SESSION'is_admin.
3. File uploads (images) are checked and stored safely.

HOW TO USE APPLICATION:

Visit the TreasureHunt Homepage by right clicking TreasureHunt.php file from treasure_hunt folder in XAMPP file in Live server.
URL: http://localhost:8080/treasure_hunt/TreasureHunt.php.
You'll see categories, featured items, and a prompt to login or register.

1. GUEST USER ACCESS:

- Browse Available Auction Items: Scroll through item sections grouped by categories like Electronics, Jewelry, phone, laptop, Fashion etc, Each item shows image, title, current price, and end time.

- Click on an Item to View Details, You will be taken to ViewItem.php page with detailed info, images, and action buttons.

- Try to Place a Bid or Add to Cart : A popup will appear:

"To buy or sell, You need to register. It takes 5 minutes to do it and then you can conveniently buy/Sell. Have Fun."

- Click Register to Continue: Proceed to the registration form.

2. REGISTERED USER ACCESS:

- Register a New Account: Go to Register.php and fill in required details and click register. A pop up message that registering succesfull will apprear and user will be diverted to Login.php.

3. ACCOUNT LOGIN:

- Enter your username and password on Login.php.
- After 3 failed attempts, you'll be redirected to the homepage, If successful, you'll be taken to the User Dashboard or redirected back to where you came from (item view).

4. BUY OR BID OR GIVE OFFER:

- From the homepage or ViewItem.php, click on an item. It will divert user to product description page. Where you can choose option of
  1. Place Bid - Enter bid amount, name, shipping address (choose default or enter new), then submit. System checks bid validity (must be higher than current highest bid and starting price).
  2. Buy Now - Redirects to ConfirmPurchase.php for final review.
  3. Make an Offer - Enter your offer amount and message (goes to seller).
  4. Add to Watchlist- tem is added to your personal Watchlist.

5. SELL AN ITEM:

- Go to SellItem.php, it will be only visible after login.
- Fill in the item details and submit. Data will get store via ProcessSellItem.php.
- View all your listings in MyListings.php, also visible in UserDashboard(Profile).

6. MANAGE ACCOUNT:

- Dashboard (UserDashboard.php): View profile, bids, watchlist, notifications.
- Notifications: See messages like offer replies or outbid alerts.

- Change Password: Use ChangePassword.php to update securely.
- Update Profile: Use UpdateProfile.php to change shipping info or contact details

7. ADMIN FEATURES:

Only Admin can access or login with AdminID and Password.

- Go to AdminPanel.php, and view Dashboard stats (Total Users, Items, Today's Bids, New Users Today), Table viewer (drop-down to select Users, Items, Bids), Export to CSV, Charts with item/category distribution via Chart.js